Queen Victoria: fact file

15 POINTS

draw her, or stick a picture here

Full name _____

Born _____

Became queen _____

Married _____

Children _____

Died _____

Reigned for _____

Five interesting facts

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____

Her life on a line



Fact bank: choose your five

15 POINTS

Read these with a grown-up. Tick the ones you like best, then copy five onto your fact file in your own words.

- [ ] Victoria became queen when she was only 18, which is three times as old as a Year 2 child.
- [ ] She was queen for 63 years. That is longer than many grandparents have been alive.
- [ ] She was small: about 4 feet 11 inches tall, which is 150 centimetres, about the height of a Year 6 child.
- [ ] She had nine children and 42 grandchildren. Imagine 42 cousins at one party!
- [ ] As a child she learned French, German, Italian and Latin: four languages, one for each season of the year.
- [ ] Her dog Dash, a King Charles spaniel, came to live with her when she was 13. On the day she was crowned, she ran upstairs afterwards to give Dash his bath.
- [ ] Late in her life she learned Hindustani, an Indian language, from her teacher Abdul Karim, who had started out serving at her table.
- [ ] In 1842 she became the first British monarch to ride on a train, from Slough to London. The trip took about half an hour.
- [ ] She was the first king or queen to live at Buckingham Palace.
- [ ] Her face was on the Penny Black, the first postage stamp in the world, in 1840. She was 21 in the picture.
- [ ] She wore a white satin wedding dress with lace. She was not the first bride in white, but her dress made white weddings popular.
- [ ] A picture of her family round a Christmas tree, printed in a newspaper in 1848, made Christmas trees popular all over Britain.
- [ ] She and Albert built Osborne House on the Isle of Wight. It took six years, from 1845 to 1851.
- [ ] She had her own bathing machine on the beach at Osborne, a hut on wheels with a veranda and curtains, so she could swim in the sea in private.
- [ ] She wrote in her diary from the age of 13 until ten days before she died: 69 years of diaries.
- [ ] After Prince Albert died in 1861 she wore black clothes for the rest of her life, about 40 years.
- [ ] In 1877 she was also made Empress of India.
- [ ] The Victoria Cross, a medal for bravery, was her idea in 1856, and the Victoria sponge cake is said to be named after her too.
- [ ] Lake Victoria and Victoria Falls in Africa, the state of Victoria in Australia and the city of Victoria in Canada are all named after her.
- [ ] Her children and grandchildren married into royal families all over Europe, so people called her "the Grandmother of Europe".
- [ ] Her record as longest-reigning monarch lasted until 9 September 2015, when Queen Elizabeth II beat it.

Name _____ Date _____

Pictures and dates

15 POINTS

Cut out a picture for your fact file. All of these are old paintings, photographs and stamps that anyone may copy.



Young Victoria, painted by Winterhalter in 1842



Photograph by Alexander Bassano, 1882



The Penny Black, 1840



The royal family in 1846, by Winterhalter

Queen Victoria's dates

24 May 1819	Born at Kensington Palace, London.
20 June 1837	Becomes queen at 18, when her uncle King William IV dies.
28 June 1838	Crowned at Westminster Abbey, aged 19.
10 Feb 1840	Marries Prince Albert at St James's Palace. Her white dress helps make white weddings popular.
6 May 1840	The Penny Black, the first postage stamp, goes on sale with her face on it.
1840 to 1857	Nine children are born.
14 Dec 1861	Prince Albert dies. Victoria wears black for the rest of her life.
1 Jan 1877	Proclaimed Empress of India.
20 June 1887	Golden Jubilee: 50 years as queen.
22 June 1897	Diamond Jubilee: 60 years as queen.
22 Jan 1901	Dies at Osborne House, aged 81, after 63 years on the throne.

Name _____ Date _____